

# Sketching

Simple sketches are very useful when planning a watercolor painting. You can develop rough ideas, sketched in pencil, into compositions, and use watercolor sketches to help you plan the colors you want to use and to practice marks and color mixes.

## USING SKETCHBOOKS

Many sketchbooks contain cartridge paper with a smooth surface. This is fine for pencil sketches, but if you want to use soft pencils, graphite sticks, and watercolor to sketch with, choose a sketchbook that contains paper with a slightly rough surface. It is a good idea to buy a pocket-size sketchbook and carry this around so that you can sketch whenever you are inspired.

Don't use watercolor paper for planning sketches, as alterations and erasings will damage the paper's surface.

### Project sketch



The drawing is done lightly, as it will remain under the washes and brushmarks of the finished painting.

A sketch for the Cherries project (see pp.52–55) was copied onto watercolor paper before painting began.

### Quick color sketch



Quick color sketches, such as this one of a lemon, are a good way to experiment with different color combinations and techniques.

### Planning a composition



This sketch has been used to plan which colors to use in a painting. Just a few brushstrokes are sufficient.